

Question:

A 34-year-old woman presents to her OB/GYN with complaints of missing her last 3 periods as well as intermittent spontaneous milky-white nipple discharge bilaterally for the past 3 months. Vital signs are stable and within normal limits. Neurologic examination is without abnormality, including normal visual fields. Serology and MRI of the brain are ordered, with results pending. Which of the following sets of laboratory results would be expected in this patient?

Answer Choices:

- A. Decreased prolactin, decreased FSH, decreased LH
- B. Decreased prolactin, increased FSH, increased LH
- C. Increased prolactin, decreased FSH, increased LH
- D. Increased prolactin, decreased FSH, decreased LH

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> To answer this question, we need to consider the patient's symptoms and likely diagnosis.

The patient's symptoms of missed periods and spontaneous milky-white nipple discharge are consistent with hyperprolactinemia, which is often caused by an increase in the levels of prolactin in the body.

The patient's age and symptoms make it likely that she has a pituitary tumor, which is a common cause of hyperprolactinemia.

A decrease in FSH and LH is not typically associated with hyperprolactinemia, as these hormones are not usually affected in this condition.

The most likely cause of the patient's symptoms is an increase in prolactin, which is often associated with a decrease in FSH and an increase in LH.

Therefore, based on the patient's symptoms and likely diagnosis, we would expect the laboratory results to show an increase in prolactin, a decrease in FSH, and an increase in LH.</think><answer> Increased prolactin, decreased FSH, increased LH </answer>

